

# INTERNATIONAL STANDARD

## Coaxial communication cables – Part 11: Sectional specification for semi-rigid cables with polyethylene (PE) dielectric



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# INTERNATIONAL STANDARD

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**Coaxial communication cables –  
Part 11: Sectional specification for semi-rigid cables with polyethylene (PE)  
dielectric**

INTERNATIONAL  
ELECTROTECHNICAL  
COMMISSION

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## INTERNATIONAL ELECTROTECHNICAL COMMISSION

## COAXIAL COMMUNICATION CABLES –

**Part 11: Sectional specification for semi-rigid cables  
with polyethylene (PE) dielectric**

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International Standard IEC 61196-11 has been prepared by subcommittee 46A: Coaxial cables, of IEC technical committee 46: Cables, wires, waveguides, R.F. connectors, R.F. and microwave passive components and accessories.

The text of this standard is based on the following documents:

| FDIS          | Report on voting |
|---------------|------------------|
| 46A/1280/FDIS | 46A/1291/RVD     |

Full information on the voting for the approval of this standard can be found in the report on voting indicated in the above table.

This publication has been drafted in accordance with the ISO/IEC Directives, Part 2.

It is to be read in conjunction with IEC 61196-1:2005, on which it is based.

A list of all parts in the IEC 61196 series, under the general title: *Coaxial communication cables*, can be found on the IEC website.

The committee has decided that the contents of this publication will remain unchanged until the stability date indicated on the IEC website under "<http://webstore.iec.ch>" in the data related to the specific publication. At this date, the publication will be

- reconfirmed,
- withdrawn,
- replaced by a revised edition, or
- amended.

A bilingual version of this publication may be issued at a later date.

## COAXIAL COMMUNICATION CABLES –

### Part 11: Sectional specification for semi-rigid cables with polyethylene (PE) dielectric

#### 1 Scope

This part of IEC 61196 applies to semi-rigid coaxial communication cables with polyethylene (PE) dielectric and tubular outer conductor. These cables are intended for use in microwave and wireless equipments or other signal transmission equipments or units at frequencies above 500 MHz.

#### 2 Normative references

The following documents, in whole or in part, are normatively referenced in this document and are indispensable for its application. For dated references, only the edition cited applies. For undated references, the latest edition of the referenced document (including any amendments) applies.

IEC 60068-1:2013, *Environmental testing – Part 1: General and guidance*

IEC 60096-0-1:2012, *Radio frequency cables – Part 1- 0: Guide to the design of detail specifications – Section 1 – Coaxial cables*

IEC 60096-0-1:2012/ AMD1:\_\_\_\_<sup>1</sup>

IEC 60332-1-2, *Tests on electric and optical fibre cables under fire conditions – Part 1-2: Test for vertical flame propagation for a single insulated wire or cable – Procedure for 1 kW pre-mixed flame*

IEC 60811-406:2012, *Electric and optical fibre cables – Test methods for non-metallic materials – Part 406: Miscellaneous tests – Resistance to stress cracking of polyethylene and polypropylene compounds*

IEC 60754-1, *Test on gases evolved during combustion of materials from cables – Part 1: Determination of the halogen acid gas content*

IEC 61034-2, *Measurement of smoke density of cables burning under defined conditions – Part 2: Test procedure and requirements*

IEC 61169-4, *Radio-frequency connectors – Part 4: RF coaxial connectors with inner diameter of outer conductor 16 mm (0,63 in) with screw lock – Characteristic impedance 50  $\Omega$  (type 7-16)*

IEC 61196-1 (all parts), *Coaxial communication cables*

IEC 61196-1:2005, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1: Generic specification – General, definitions and requirements*

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<sup>1</sup> To be published.

IEC 61196-1-1, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-1: Capability approval for coaxial cables*

IEC 61196-1-101, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-101: Electrical test methods – Test for conductor d.c. resistance of cable*

IEC 61196-1-102, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-102: Electrical test methods – Test for insulation resistance of cable dielectric*

IEC 61196-1-103, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-103: Electrical test methods – Test for capacitance of cable*

IEC 61196-1-105, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-105: Electrical test methods – Test for withstand voltage of cable dielectric*

IEC 61196-1-106, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-106: Electrical test methods – Test for withstand voltage of cable sheath*

IEC 61196-1-108, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-108: Electrical test methods – Test for characteristic impedance, phase and group delay, electrical length and propagation velocity*

IEC 61196-1-110, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-110: Electrical test methods – Test for continuity*

IEC 61196-1-112, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-112: Electrical test methods – Test for return loss*

IEC 61196-1-113, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-113: Electrical test methods – Test for attenuation constant*

IEC 61196-1-115, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-115: Electrical test methods – Test for regularity of impedance (pulse/step function return loss)*

IEC 61196-1-119, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-119: Electrical test methods – RF power rating*

IEC 61196-1-201:2009, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-201: Environmental test methods – Test for cold bend performance of cable*

IEC 61196-1-203, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-203: Environmental test methods – Test for water penetration of cable*

IEC 61196-1-206, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-206: Environmental test methods – Climatic sequence*

IEC 61196-1-215, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-215: Environmental test methods – High temperature cable ageing<sup>2</sup>*

IEC 61196-1-301, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-301: Mechanical test methods – Test for ovality*

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<sup>2</sup> To be published.



IEC 61196-1-302, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-302: Mechanical test methods – Test for eccentricity*

IEC 61196-1-313, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-313: Mechanical test methods – Adhesion of dielectric and sheath*

IEC 61196-1-314, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-314: Mechanical test methods – Test for bending*

IEC 61196-1-316, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-316: Mechanical test methods – Test of maximum pulling force of cable*

IEC 61196-1-317, *Coaxial communication cables – Part 1-317: Mechanical test methods – Test for crush resistance of cable*

IEC TR 62222:2012, *Fire performance of communication cables installed in buildings*

IEC 62037-4, *Passive RF and microwave devices, intermodulation level measurement – Part 4: Measurement of passive intermodulation in coaxial cables*

IEC 62153-4-3, *Metallic communication cable test methods – Part 4-3: Electromagnetic compatibility (EMC) – Surface transfer impedance – Triaxial method*

IEC 62153-4-4, *Metallic communication cable test methods – Part 4-4: Electromagnetic compatibility (EMC) – Test method for measuring of the screening attenuation as up to and above 3 GHz, triaxial method*

IEC 62230, *Electric cables – Spark-test method*

EN 50289-4-17, *Communication cables – Specifications for test methods – Part 4-17: Test methods for UV resistance evaluation of the sheath of electrical and optical fibre cable*

### **3 Terms and definitions**

For the purposes of this document, the terms and definitions given in IEC 61196-1 apply.

## **4 Materials and cable construction**

### **4.1 Cable construction**

The cable construction shall be in accordance with 4.2 to 4.5 of this part of IEC 61196 and the requirements stated in the detail specification.

### **4.2 Inner conductor**

#### **4.2.1 Conductor material**

Subclause 4.4.1 of IEC 61196-1:2005 applies.

The inner conductor material shall be as stated in the relevant cable detail specification.

#### **4.2.2 Conductor construction**

The conductor shall consist of a solid or strand wire or corrugated or smooth tube.

In addition, 4.4.4 of IEC 61196-1:2005 applies.

The inner conductor diameter shall be stated in the detail specification.

For corrugated inner conductor, peak diameter and root diameter and pitch shall be specified in the detail specification.

The tolerance of the inner conductor shall be specified in the detail specification.

### **4.3 Dielectric**

The material of dielectric shall be polyethylene (PE).

The construction of the dielectric shall be one of the following:

- solid dielectric,
- air spaced dielectric,
- semi air spaced dielectric (e.g. cellular polyethylene dielectric).

For cable with corrugated outer conductor, the nominal diameter of dielectric shall be specified in the detail specification.

For cable with smooth tube out conductor, the diameter and tolerance of dielectric shall be stated in the detail specification.

### **4.4 Outer conductor**

The outer conductor material shall be as stated in the relevant cable detail specification.

The conductor shall consist of a corrugated or smooth tube.

In addition, the requirements of 4.6.1 of IEC 61196-1:2005 apply.

The diameter and thickness of the outer conductor shall be specified in the detail specification.

For corrugated outer conductor, peak diameter and root diameter and pitch shall be as specified in the detail specification.

The tolerance on the outer conductor shall be specified in the detail specification.

### **4.5 Sheath**

The sheath of a cable shall be in accordance with 4.7 of IEC 61196-1:2005 with the following amendments and additions:

- a) The material of cable sheath shall be specified in the detail specification.
- b) The diameter and minimum thickness and tolerance of sheath shall be as stated in the detail specification.
- c) For cables intended for outdoor use or exposed to sunlight, the cable shall pass the UV stability test according to EN 50289-4-17, an IEC test procedure is under consideration.
- d) For special cable constructions, a sheath may not be necessary.

## 5 Standard rating and characteristics

### 5.1 Nominal characteristic wave impedance

The nominal characteristic impedance shall be 50  $\Omega$ .

### 5.2 Rated temperature range

The ratings temperature range applicable to each cable shall be specified herein or in the detail specification. See Table 1.

**Table 1 – Rated temperature**

| Parameter                      | Requirements/remarks                  |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Operational temperature range  | Specified in the detail specification |
| Storage temperature range      | Specified in the detail specification |
| Installation temperature range | Specified in the detail specification |

### 5.3 Operating frequency

Operating frequency range shall be specified in the detail specification.

### 5.4 Average and peak power

Average and peak power shall be specified herein or in the detail specification.

## 6 Identification, marking and labelling

### 6.1 Cable identification

Subclause 6.1 of IEC 61196-1:2005 applies.

### 6.2 Cable marking

The cable marking shall be applied to the sheath. The marking shall consist of the IEC cable type number as given in 6.1.1 of IEC 61196-1:2005 and/or the manufacturer's designated marking when specified in the detail specification.

### 6.3 Labelling

Labelling shall be provided in accordance with 6.3 of IEC 61196-1:2005 and the detail specification.

## 7 Requirements of finished cables

### 7.1 General

For finished cables, the requirements given below shall apply when they are tested in accordance with the IEC 61196-1 series or Clause 8 of this part of IEC 61196.

Unless otherwise specified, all measurements shall be carried out under standard atmospheric conditions for testing in accordance with Clause 5 of IEC 60068-1:2013.

Applicable test methods shall be in accordance with the IEC 61196-1-n series and other test methods specified herein.

## 7.2 Electrical requirements

Electrical measurements are given in Table 2.

**Table 2 – Electrical requirements**

| Subclause | Test procedure                 | Parameter                                            | Requirements/Remarks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7.2.1     | IEC 61196-1-110                | Continuity                                           | Inner conductor shall be continuous.<br>Outer conductor shall be continuous.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 7.2.2     | IEC 61196-1-101                | Inner and outer conductor direct current resistance  | Value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.2.3     | IEC 61196-1-105                | Withstand voltage of dielectric                      | Value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.2.4     | IEC 61196-1-106 (or IEC 62230) | Withstand voltage of sheath (or spark test)          | Unless otherwise specified in the detail specification, the following test voltage shall be applied for one minute.<br>2 kV r.m.s. for sheath thickness over 0,5 mm and less than 0,8 mm.<br>3 kV r.m.s. for sheath thickness over 0,8 mm and less than 1,0 mm.<br>5 kV r.m.s. for sheath thickness over 1,0 mm.<br>(Spark test voltage and duration in accordance with the detail specification) |
| 7.2.5     | IEC 61196-1-102                | Insulation resistance                                | $\geq 104 \text{ M}\Omega \cdot \text{km}$                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 7.2.6     | IEC 61196-1-103                | Capacitance                                          | Value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.2.7     | IEC 61196-1-108                | Mean characteristic wave impedance                   | 50 $\Omega$ , tolerance shall be in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 7.2.8     | IEC 61196-1-115                | Regularity of impedance                              | Value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.2.9     | IEC 61196-1-112                | Return loss                                          | Value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.2.10    | IEC 61196-1-113                | Attenuation constant                                 | Value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.2.11    | IEC 61196-1-215                | High temperature cable aging (Attenuation stability) | See 7.3.1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 7.2.12    | IEC 62037-4                    | Passive intermodulation (IM)                         | When required, both ends of the specimen should be attached with suitable RF connectors (recommended type 7-16 connectors, according to IEC 61169-4).<br>Input signal frequencies and power of $f_1$ and $f_2$ and the minimum PIM requirement shall be specified in the relevant detail specification.                                                                                           |
| 7.2.13    | IEC 61196-1-119                | RF power rating                                      | When required, value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 7.2.14    | IEC 60096-0-1                  | Peak power                                           | When required, value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 7.2.15    | IEC 62153-4-3                  | Transfer impedance                                   | If applicable, value in accordance with the relevant detail specification.<br>If not otherwise specified in the detail specification, the transfer impedance shall be tested after completion of the cable bending test (IEC 61196-1-314) to the detail specification.                                                                                                                            |
| 7.2.16    | IEC 62153-4-4                  | Screening attenuation                                | If applicable, value in accordance with the relevant detail specification.<br>If not otherwise specified in the detail specification, the screening attenuation shall be tested after completion of the cable bending test (IEC 61196-1-314) to the detail specification.<br>An alternative test method can be used when specified in the detail specification.                                   |

### 7.3 Environmental requirements

Environmental requirements are given in Table 3.

**Table 3 – Environmental requirements**

| Subclause | Test procedure                    | Parameter                           | Requirements/remarks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7.3.1     | IEC 61196-1-215                   | Ageing                              | <p>When applicable, the temperature value is:</p> <p>98 °C ± 2 °C (PVC sheath)</p> <p>90 °C ± 2 °C (LSZH and PE sheath)</p> <p>Duration: 168 h or as specified in detail specification.</p> <p>Requirements after ageing and cooling down to standard atmospheric conditions for testing in accordance with Clause 5 of IEC 60068-1: 2013:</p> <p>a) The return loss shall remain within the specified limits in Table 2.</p> <p>b) The attenuation shall remain within the specified limits in Table 2.</p> <p>c) No cracks in the inner conductor (when needed) and sheath.</p> <p>d) No visible black spots in the outer conductor.</p> |
| 7.3.2     | Method C of IEC 61196-1-201: 2009 | Cold bend performance               | <p>The temperature at bend shall be defined in the detail specification.</p> <p>No cracks, flaws or other damage in the jacket material and outer conductor.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 7.3.3     | IEC 61196-1-203                   | Water penetration                   | When required, in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.3.4     | IEC 61196-1-206                   | Climatic sequence                   | <p>When required, <i>CUT</i> shall be specified in the detail specification.</p> <p><math>T_A</math> = minimum environmental rated temperature</p> <p><math>T_B</math> = maximum environmental rated temperature</p> <p><math>t_1</math> = 16 h, unless otherwise specified in the detail specification.</p> <p>Humidity: 55 °C, 93 % RH 1 day (after cold and heat)</p> <p>Number of cycles: 2, unless otherwise specified in the detail specification.</p> <p>No physical damages shall be visible in cable.</p> <p>The return loss shall remain within the specified limits in Table 2.</p>                                             |
| 7.3.5     | IEC 60811-406                     | Environmental stress cracking       | No physical damages shall be visible in cable.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 7.3.6     | EN 50289-4-17                     | Ultraviolet stability of the sheath | <p>When applicable (see 4.5), the test procedure shall be specified in the detail specification</p> <p>Requirements:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>– no visual cracks;</li> <li>– changes in elongation and tensile strength after test shall be specified in the detail specification.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

## 7.4 Mechanical requirements

Mechanical requirements of the finished cables are given in Table 4.

**Table 4 – Mechanical requirements**

| Subclause | Test methods            | Parameter                                     | Requirements/remarks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7.4.1     | 4.2 of IEC 61196-1:2005 | Visual examination                            | The sheath shall be free of cracks, splits, irregularities, and imbedded foreign material.<br><br>The outer conductor shall be free of black spots or cracks.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 7.4.2     | 4.3 of IEC 61196-1:2005 | Dimensional examination                       | Value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.4.3     | IEC 61196-1-301         | Ovality of inner conductor                    | When applicable, value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 7.4.4     | IEC 61196-1-302         | Eccentricity of dielectric                    | When applicable, value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 7.4.5     | IEC 61196-1-313         | Adhesion of dielectric                        | When applicable, value in accordance with the detail specification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 7.4.6     | IEC 61196-1-314         | Cable bending                                 | One of the following methods and requirements shall be specified in the detail specification.<br><br>a) Single bending (Clause 4, Procedure 2):single bend radius.<br><br>b) Repeated bending (Clause 5):multiple bend radius and number of bends.<br><br>Requirements:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• The maximum impedance irregularity shall be <math>\leq 1</math> %, when measured in accordance with IEC 61196-1-115.</li><li>• The return loss shall remain within the specified limits in Table 2.</li><li>• No physical damage in cable.</li></ul> When applicable, PIM shall remain within the specified limits in Table 2. |
| 7.4.7     | IEC 61196-1-316         | Tensile strength of cable (longitudinal pull) | The force shall be specified in the detail specification.<br><br>Requirements:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• The maximum impedance irregularity shall be <math>\leq 1</math> %, when measured in accordance with IEC 61196-1-115.</li><li>• The return loss shall remain within the specified limits in Table 2.</li><li>• No physical damage in cable.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 7.4.8     | IEC 61196-1-317         | Crush resistance of cable                     | When applicable, the load shall be specified in the detail specification, applied for 2 min.<br><br>Requirements:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• The maximum impedance irregularity shall be <math>\leq 1</math> %, when measured in accordance with IEC 61196-1-115.</li><li>• The return loss shall remain within the specified limits in Table 2.</li><li>• No physical damage of the sheath.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

## 7.5 Fire performance requirements

When intended to be installed in constructions, these cables may fall under the requirements of local, regional or governmental regulations for fire and safety standards.

Table 5 outlines some fire tests for which the use is detailed in IEC TR 62222.

**Table 5 – Fire performance requirements**

| Subclause | Test procedure      | Parameter                 | Requirements/Remarks                                 |
|-----------|---------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 7.5.1     | IEC 60332-1-2       | Flame propagation         | When required, according to the detail specification |
| 7.5.2     | IEC 60754-1         | Halogen acid gas emission | When required, according to the detail specification |
| 7.5.3     | Under consideration | Toxic gas emission        | When required, according to the detail specification |
| 7.5.4     | IEC 61034-2         | Smoke density             | When required, according to the detail specification |

## 8 Quality assessment

Quality assessment shall be in accordance with IEC 61196-1-1.

## 9 Delivery and storage

Delivery of cables shall be in accordance with Clause 9 of IEC 61196-1:2005.







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